fail, so refute_equal passes if the two arguments are not equal. These are occasionally useful, but go light on them; most people find negative logic harder to reason about.

Rails ActiveSupport provides a subclass called ActiveSupport::TestCase that provides a handful of shortcuts and goodies:

- The ability to load data from fixtures before tests
- The declarative test "test name" do syntax described earlier
- The assertions assert_difference and assert_no_difference
- Support for asserting the existence of Rails deprecations, unlikely to be helpful unless you're working on Rails itself
- Logging support to put the test class and test name in the Rails test.log before each test
- Support for multiple setup and teardown blocks, defined with the method name, similar to RSpec before and after blocks

Running Minitest

Rails provides some standard tasks for running all or part of the test suite.

The one to use most of the time, which is not the Rails default, is rails test (often bin/rails test, depending on how your bundle is set up); it grabs any files ending with _test.rb in the test directory or any of its subdirectories (except for system tests) and executes them through Minitest. For running a single file or directory, Minitest and Rails use the syntax rails test test/models/task_test.rb. For now let's assume you're using rails test. In Chapter 16, *Running Tests Faster and Running Faster Tests*, on page 319, I'll cover better ways to focus test execution.

When you run racks test, the Rake task identifies any files matching the pattern test/**/*_test.rb and passes them all to Minitest. (The related task rails test:db first resets the database using db:test:prepare.) Once Minitest gets the list of matching files, it does the following for each file:

- The Ruby interpreter loads the file. In a Rails context, the line require test_helper is important, as the test_helper file includes global and Rails-specific setup.
- Inside any subclass of Minitest::Test, Minitest identifies test methods in the file—either because the method name starts with test or because you're using the ActiveSupport test method directly.